

Newborough Warren Weather & Water Watch

August 2026

Weather

Metric	Bodorgan (IBODOR6)	Llanfair (ILLANF24)	RAF Valley	Typical August
Total rainfall	84.1 mm	73.7 mm	39.2 mm	~69.4 mm
Average high			20.9 °C	18.8 °C
Average low			14.3 °C	13.1 °C
Sunshine			187.7 h	176.3 h

RAF Valley is the regional reference station; the two private gauges are on Anglesey closer to the reserve. Typical values are 1991–2020 Met Office averages for RAF Valley.

August brought 39.2 mm of rain at RAF Valley, 57% of the 69.4 mm average — the 18th driest August in a 96-year record. On its own that is unremarkable. What makes this August matter is what came before it.

July 2026 was the driest July in the entire RAF Valley record. 4.8 mm fell, against a July average of 57.7 mm, and no July in 96 years of observation has been drier. Taken together, June to August delivered 102 mm against an average of 184 mm, making this the 9th driest summer in 95 years. The reserve entered August with its water table already unusually low, and August's near-average-looking rainfall had a deficit to work against rather than a normal starting point.

The rain that did fall arrived late and in two bursts. At the Bodorgan gauge, rain fell on 12 of the month's 31 days, and 78 of the month's 84 mm fell in the second half. A dry spell ran 13 days from 5 to 17 August. The wettest day was 27 August with 21.8 mm, within a wet spell of 26–31 August that delivered 44.4 mm; an earlier spell of 18–21 August gave 32.3 mm. Because the well round was driven on 30 August, the last of that rain had barely reached the water table when the levels below were read.

The three gauges disagree more than usual this month, from 39.2 mm at RAF Valley to 84.1 mm at Bodorgan. Both private gauges recorded a complete month with no suspect daily spikes, so the spread looks like real geography — the late-August rain was heavier over the south of the island than at Valley — rather than a faulty instrument. All three are reported here rather than one being chosen.

Water levels

The well round on 30 August covered 70 dipwells. Levels are predominantly falling: 61 wells fell, 5 rose and 4 were stable within ± 0.01 m. The mean change since the July round was -0.11

m, with a range of -0.33 m to +0.12 m.

This is consistent with a water table still drawing down through the driest summer in almost a century, with the month's rain arriving too late in the month to show in this round. Whether late August's rain has begun the autumn recovery will be visible in the September round, not this one.

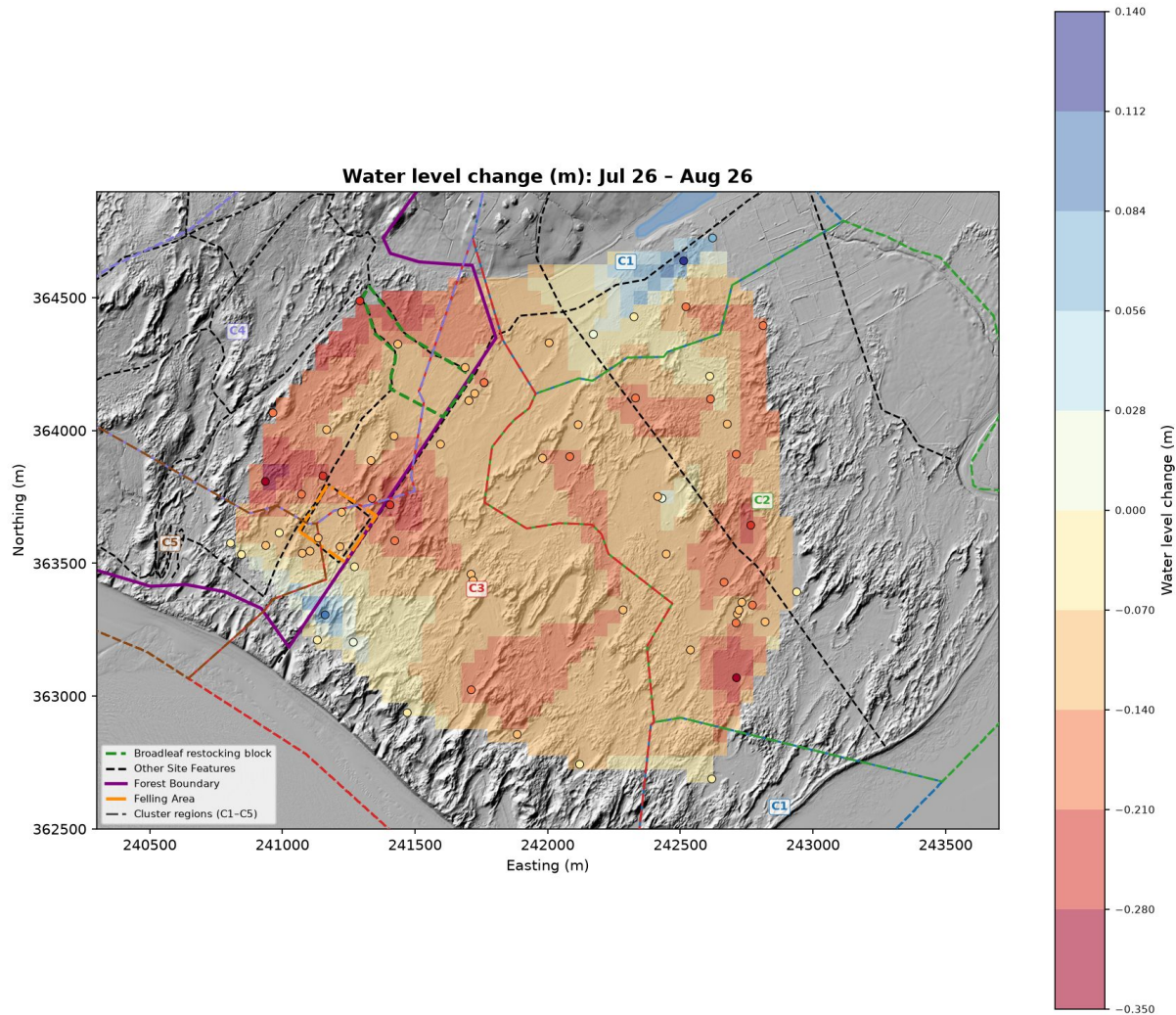
Where the fall was deepest

Group	Wells	Mean change (m)	Range (m)
C4 Main Forest	9	-0.18	-0.33 to -0.11
C2 Dune	23	-0.13	-0.29 to +0.02
Not in the classified network	7	-0.12	-0.27 to +0.00
C3 Western Residual	19	-0.10	-0.18 to +0.10
C5 Coastal Forest	5	-0.07	-0.13 to -0.01
C1 Lake Edge	7	-0.02	-0.16 to +0.12

The pattern follows the reserve's hydrological groupings closely. The **Main Forest** wells under the Corsican pine canopy fell furthest, averaging -0.18 m — consistent with the higher evaporative demand and interception of a conifer canopy in a dry month. The open **Dune** wells followed at -0.13 m. The **Lake Edge** cluster barely moved at -0.02 m, which is what the lake buffering those slacks would lead you to expect, and it holds two of the month's five risers.

The largest falls were ceh33 (-0.33 m, C4), D38 (-0.29 m, C2), ceh14 (-0.28 m, C4). The only meaningful rises were ceh25 (+0.12 m, C1), ceh36 (+0.10 m, C3), ceh6 (+0.07 m, C1).

(Cluster labels come from the study's five-way partition of the monitoring network. Seven of the wells read this month sit outside that classified network and are grouped separately above.)

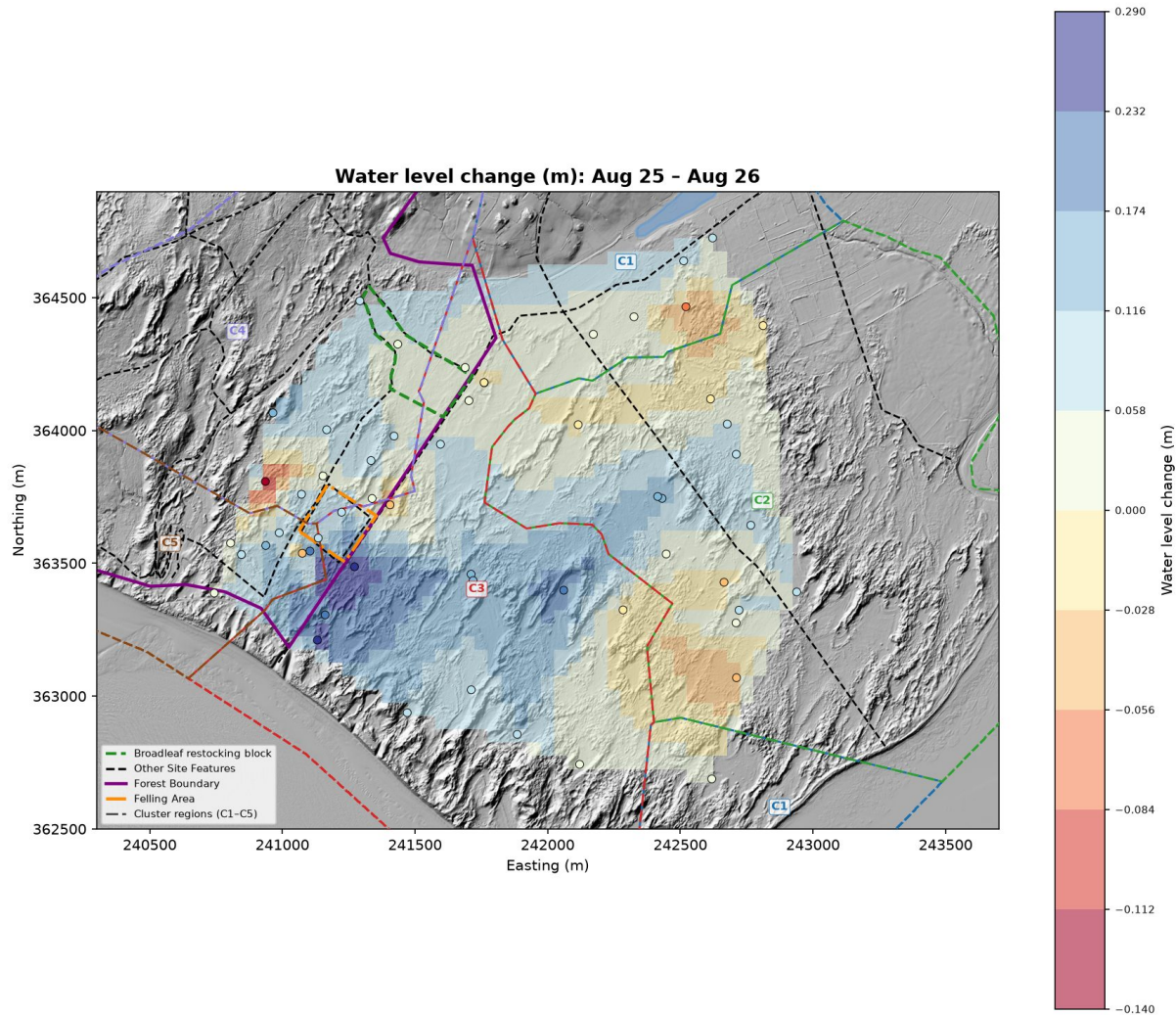


Water level change from July 2026 to August 2026. Blue is rising, red is falling. Dashed coloured outlines are the five cluster regions, labelled C1 to C5. C1's detached south-eastern cell is CEH11, which belongs to the cluster by coefficient behaviour rather than by proximity to the lake.

Compared with a year ago

August 2025 was itself last year's summer minimum, so this year the two usual comparisons — against the same month last year, and against the last summer low — are one and the same measurement.

Against August 2025, 41 of the 60 wells with readings in both months are higher by more than 0.01 m. Levels stand +0.06 m above that low on average, ranging from -0.12 m to +0.27 m. The **Western Residual** block gained most, averaging +0.09 m; the **Lake Edge** wells gained least at +0.02 m, which is the mirror image of their stability month to month.



Water level change from August 2025 to August 2026. Because August 2025 was last year's summer low, this is both the year-on-year comparison and the rebound from that low.

Is this a normal August?

Broadly, yes. Across the 74 wells read in both months, levels fell 0.106 m from July to August. Comparing that with the same July-to-August step in every previous year of the record:

	Site mean July → August change
August 2026	-0.106 m
Median of 20 previous years	-0.089 m
Mean of 20 previous years	-0.049 m
Wettest outcome on record (2020)	+0.310 m
Driest outcome on record (2010)	-0.254 m

August 2026's fall is slightly deeper than the typical year, but 8 of the 20 previous years saw a

larger one. The record-breaking dry July has not, so far, produced a record-breaking drop in the water table, and the reserve sits marginally above where it stood at the same point last year. That is worth stating plainly, because the two facts pull in opposite directions and only the second is a measure of the aquifer itself.

The biggest and smallest movers

Well locations are not listed here. The whole monitoring network is mapped, well by well, at [the Newborough dipwell map](#).

Largest falls

Well	Group	Change (m)
ceh33	C4	-0.33
D38	C2	-0.29
ceh14	C4	-0.28
LIS1	—	-0.27
WMC1	C2	-0.23
ceh20	C4	-0.22
L7	C2	-0.20
T41a	C2	-0.20

The month's risers — every well that rose by more than 0.01 m

Well	Group	Change (m)
ceh25	C1	+0.12
ceh36	C3	+0.10
ceh6	C1	+0.07
nw4	C2	+0.02
ceh18	C3	+0.02

Barely moved — the wells that changed by 0.01 m or less, the four counted as stable above

Well	Group	Change (m)
ceh26	C1	+0.01
ceh3	—	+0.00
ceh40	C3	+0.00
ceh19	C5	-0.01

Across all 70 wells the mean change was -0.11 m, with a range of -0.33 m to +0.12 m.

Sources. Water levels: Newborough Warren dipwell network, round of 30 August 2026. Climate: Met Office RAF Valley station record (1930–2026, August 2026 provisional), and Weather Underground stations IBODOR6 and ILLANF24. Cluster groupings and the region outlines on the maps: the study's five-way partition of the monitoring network, drawn as nearest-well regions around the 66 reference wells — a rendering of which well governs where, not a mapped hydrological boundary. Historical July-to-August comparisons are computed over wells read in

both months of the year in question, so the well count varies by year.